Township of NIPISSING
"Life the way it should be" 1888

The Corporation of the Township of Nipissing
45 Beatty Street
Nipissing ON P0H 1W0
Telephone 705-724-2144 Fax 705-724-5385
www.nipissingtownship.com

REPORT TO COUNCIL

Date: November 7, 2023

From: Kris Croskery-Hodgins, Municipal Administrator

Re: Final Draft Strategic Plan 2023-2026

BACKGROUND/OVERVIEW

Council began working towards an updated Strategic Plan with review work, Town Hall meetings, a request for public input and an open discussion at the October 3, 2023 Council meeting.

One revision from the original draft is contained in the Local Historical and Natural Heritage Features section.

An objective regarding Protect Natural Heritage Features is contained within Part 5 of the Township of Nipissing adopted Official Plan, September 5, 2017. The Official Plan and Zoning By-Law provide mapping of Natural Heritage Features and layout the protections in place during any proposed development.

Including this objective with the Official Plan Updates will provide a clearer message of how this is achieved.

Respectfully,

Kris Croskery-Hodgins, Municipal Administrator

STRATEGIC PLAN 2023-2026



TOWNSHIP OF NIPISSING

DRAFT

Township of NIPISSING

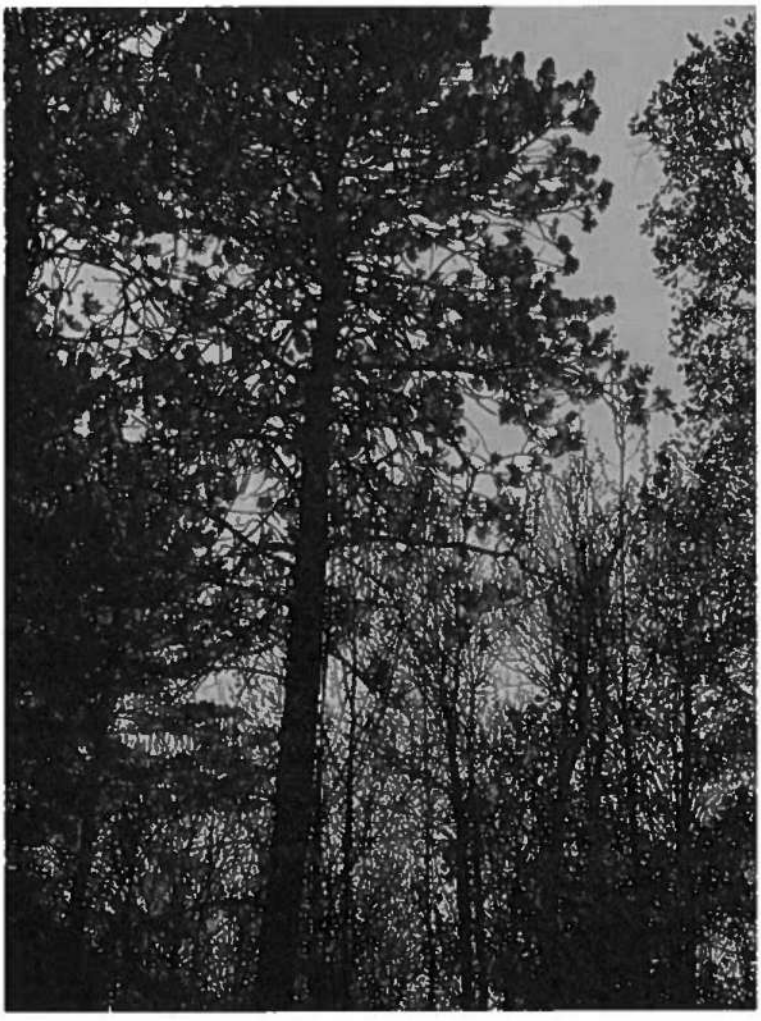
"Life the way it should be" ESTABLISHED 1888

Strategic Planning for the Township of Nipissing

The Corporation of the Township of Nipissing was incorporated on February 10, 1888. On January 1, 1970, the Township of Nipissing annexed the unincorporated Township of Gurd. The Township is a rural community with three designated Hamlet areas.

The Strategic Plan for the Township of Nipissing encompasses community values, natural heritage features, quality of life and a shared vision of the future as gathered from the residents during Town Hall meetings and gathered input from a variety of sources.

Tourism is an important economic driver of the Township with Lake Nipissing a draw for many. Maintaining a safe, stable municipality allows residents to grow and thrive, providing Life the Way it Should Be.



Council 2023-2026

Left to right:
Dave Yemm, Councillor; Shelly Foote, Councillor; Tom Piper, Mayor; Stephen Kirkey, Councillor; and Tom Butler, Councillor.



Council Contact Information:

Mayor Tom Piper
Email: piper@nipissingtownship.com

Councillor Tom Butler
Email: butler@nipissingtownship.com

Councillor Stephen Kirkey
Email: kirkey@nipissingtownship.com

Councillor Shelly Foote
Email: foote@nipissingtownship.com

Councillor Dave Yemm
Email: dyemm@nipissingtownship.com

COUNCIL MEETINGS:

Council meetings are held at the Township of Nipissing Community Centre, 2381 Hwy 654. Meeting schedules are set at the beginning of each year and are listed on the Township of Nipissing website. Council Agendas, Minutes and Agenda Packages are available on the website. Council meetings are open to the public and everyone is welcome to attend in person, view the livestream of the meeting or view a recording of the meeting posted on the Township of Nipissing YouTube channel.

Message from the Mayor

On behalf of Council and Staff, I would like to thank everyone who participated in the Town Hall Meetings. Your input was appreciated and helped us determine elements in our plan.

We are attempting to present the plan in a new format which we hope will be easier to comprehend. With the new term of Council this year, many new initiatives have begun to meet numerous issues left over from the previous Councils and the pandemic.

The Township of Nipissing continues to work on your behalf through this plan to keep "Life the Way it Should Be".

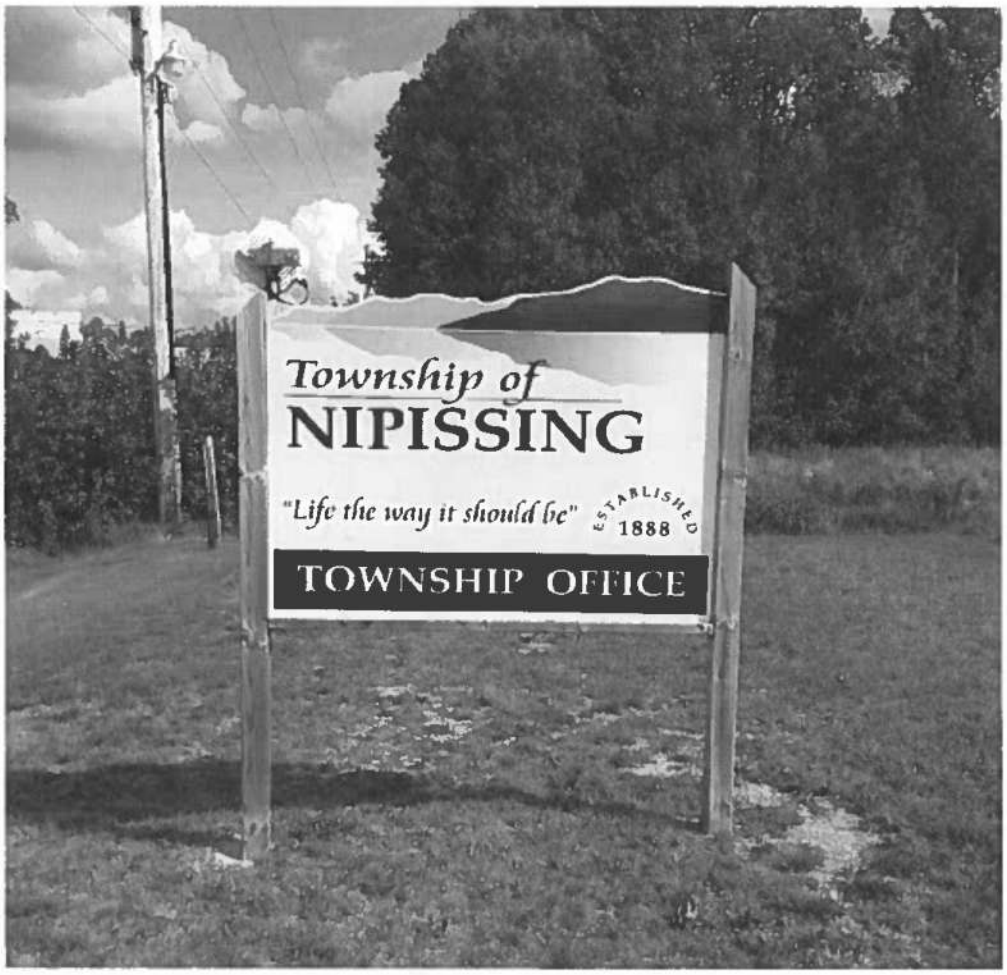
Tom Piper, Mayor



Purpose of a Strategic Plan

Strategic planning is a process used to define the direction of the municipality, anticipate future needs and establish realistic and attainable goals and objectives. The plan allows the municipality to effectively allocate resources and provide growth that is fiscally responsible and maintainable.

Town Hall meetings were held to gather input from the residents for the strategic vision of the Township.



Governance Framework

Role of Council

Municipal Act, s. 224

- To represent the public and to consider the well-being and interests of the municipality.
- To develop and evaluate the policies and programs of the municipality.
- To determine which services the municipality provides.
- To ensure that administrative and controllership policies, practices and procedures are in place to implement the decisions of council.
- To ensure the accountability and transparency of operations of the municipality, including the activities of the senior management of the municipality.
- To maintain the financial integrity of the municipality.
- To carry out the duties of council under the Municipal Act.

Role of Staff

Municipal Act, s. 227

- To implement council's decisions and establish administrative practices and procedures to carry out council's decisions.
- To undertake research and provide advice to council on the policies and programs of the municipality.
- To carry out other duties required under the Municipal Act and other duties assigned by the municipality.

Mission Statement

The Township of Nipissing is dedicated to maintaining its rural township atmosphere and its safe, healthy environment through the provision of effective and efficient government and planning, for the benefit of residents and visitors.

Vision Statement

The Township of Nipissing is a proactive community that respects and protects its history while enhancing and embracing the needs of residents and guests, and the opportunities provided by its natural resources.

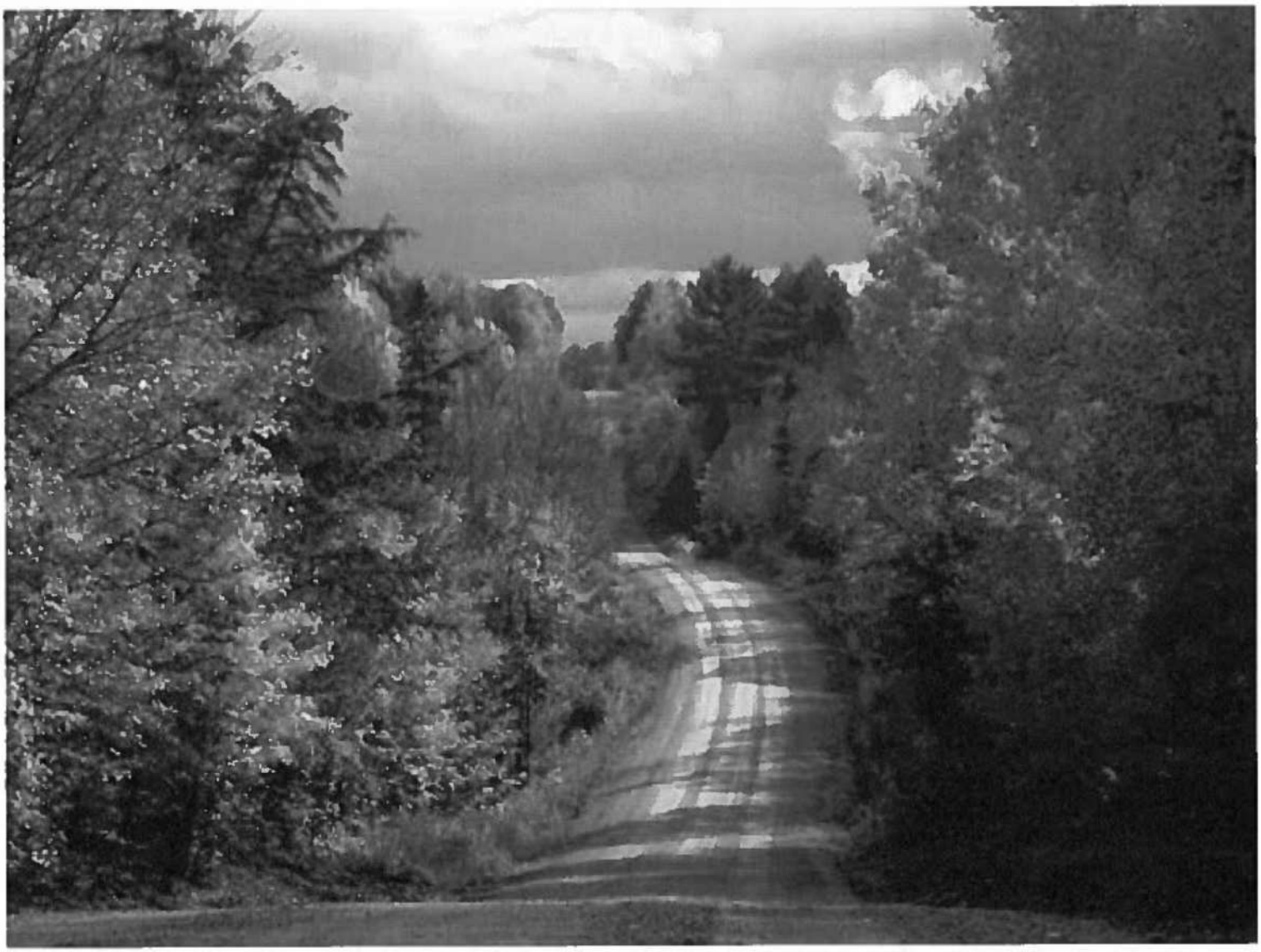
Core Value Statements

- Culture and excellent customer service.
- History and heritage.
- Quality services for citizens and visitors.
- Open and transparent governance.
- Honesty and integrity.
- Inclusion and diversity.
- Fairness and equality.
- Commitment to a team of creative problem solvers.
- Accountability to residents.
- Respect for the natural environment.

Township Key Priorities

Strategic Areas of Focus:

- Effective and Efficient Municipal Services
- Local Historical and Natural Heritage Features
- Sustainable Community Growth and Prosperity
- Maintaining "Life the way it should be"



Effective and Efficient Municipal Services

Goal: To ensure the provision of effective and progressive communication with residents and visitors while maintaining municipal services and meeting the needs of the community.

Objective	Method	Timeline
Asset Management Planning	a) Road Needs Study – 2023 b) Asset Management Plan update c) 10 Year Capital Forecast Budgeting	a) by year end 2023 b) by year end 2023 c) started in 2023
Levels of Service	Service Delivery Review	2024-2025
Operational Review	a) Operational Review b) Human Resources Policy Review – Market compensation study, pay equity review	a) RFP for 2024 b) RFP for 2024
Waste Diversion – Landfill Management	a) Expansion request Bear Creek Landfill to MOE b) Expansion request Wolfe Lake Landfill to MOE c) Recycling Services transfer to Provincial authority	a) In progress 2023 b) 2025-2026 c) October 2025
Communication with Residents	a) Communication Strategy Document b) Website information updates and improvements	a) 2024 b) 2023 and ongoing



Local Historical and Natural Heritage Features

Goal: To celebrate and promote the natural heritage features and local history of the Township of Nipissing while providing education and preserving the past.

Objective	Method	Timeline
Strategic Planning for the Nipissing Township Museum	a) Strategic Planning document b) Cataloguing Software for Museum collection c) Consistent Leadership and Management of the Museum	a) 2024 b) 2024 Budget c) 2024
Official Plan updates	Following the Provincial Policy Statement and the Ontario Planning Act for all necessary updates to the Official Plan of the Township of Nipissing a) Form a working relationship with Indigenous groups to ensure any significant areas are protected during development/sale b) Consult with Ontario Heritage Trust to identify areas of significance during development/sale	Update to begin 2027 a) Immediately b) Immediately
Zoning By-Law updates	Following the Official Plan of the Township of Nipissing.	Update to begin following approval of the Official Plan (2027 update) by the Minister of Municipal Affairs and Housing



Sustainable Community Growth and Prosperity

Goal: To sustain and support the current "quality of life", natural environment, and community partners in local and home-based businesses to provide sustainable growth and development opportunities in the Township of Nipissing.

Objective	Method	Timeline
Property Standards – with a common-sense approach and rural flavour.	a) work towards a licensing model for short term rental properties including methods of enforcement for excessive noise and disruption. Working with area municipalities for provide a common framework to provide consistency in the sector. b) investigate a property standards policy, clean yard by-law, for acceptable restrictions that are enforceable within the Township of Nipissing.	a) 2023 and ongoing b) 2024-2025
Housing opportunities.	a) Working within the Official Plan, Zoning By-Law and provincial land planning policies, support growth and development of municipal lands working with local property owners.	a) immediate and ongoing
Support local business/industry for sustainable growth.	a) Improve local business directory listing on the Township of Nipissing website. b) Provide education materials to explain the home-based industry requirements in the Township of Nipissing Zoning By-Law. c) Continue to defer development charges for new buildings to encourage growth and development in the Township of Nipissing.	a) 2023-2024 b) 2024 c) immediate and ongoing

Sustainable Community Growth and Prosperity (Continued)		
Objective	**Method**	**Timeline**
Support improvements to resident safety and well-being.	a) Work with the Ontario Provincial Police to regulate the speed concerns along municipal roadways. Including using radar speed signs and public education.	a) 2023 and ongoing
	b) Monitor and update the Community Safety and Well-Being Plan annually with local partners.	b) annually
	c) Community Risk Assessment	c) 2024



Maintaining "Life the way it should be"

Goal: To expand and support the physical, social and environmental opportunities that exist within the Township of Nipissing through community programming and growth.

Objective	Method	Timeline
Support and improve community facilities for recreation.	a) Strategic Planning document for Recreation facilities. b) Inclusive and open Recreation Committee communication with the residents. A survey to be distributed to residents for input on recreation programming. c) Improvements to the outdoor rink facility and Heritage Park.	a) 2024 b) immediate and ongoing c) 2024-2025
Invest in repairs and maintenance to Water Access areas.	a) Repairs to Chapman's Landing Dock. b) Upgrades at McQuaby Lake boat launch area – including moving parking to an improved area. c) Maintenance and improvements to the municipal beach areas on Lake Nipissing and Wolfe Lake Beach.	a) 2023-2024 b) 2024-2025 c) immediate and ongoing
Promote, support and invest in volunteerism	a) Work with local partners to promote volunteering and programming across the area. b) Create a volunteer network for all programming, celebrating community involvement and recognizing contributions.	a) immediate and ongoing b) 2023-2024





2023-2026 Township of Nipissing Strategic Plan

Contact Information:
Township of Nipissing
45 Beatty Street, Nipissing ON P0H 1W0
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To our acclaimed Mayor and elected council,

I am writing to provide feedback on the DRAFT strategic plan for 2023-2026. In the introductory section of this plan, the township quotes:

"Strategic planning is a process used to define the direction of the municipality, anticipate future needs and establish realistic and attainable goals and objectives. The plan allows the municipality to effectively allocate resources and provide growth that is fiscally responsible and maintainable."

However, this plan seems to fall short in clearly defining the means to achieve most of its objectives. Furthermore, I noticed an omission of numerous community concerns that were directly shared with you, as solicited by many ratepayers, during the town hall meetings. It's also worth noting that the format of these meetings didn't truly foster an environment for candid feedback, opinions, and ideas from the ratepayers. We anticipate and hope for a more engaging and inclusive approach in the future. I strongly suggest organizing a few more meetings, with a renewed focus on genuinely listening to the concerns and ideas of your community.

Speaking to effective and efficient municipal services:

1. **Asset Management Planning**
    - What criteria will be used to determine the priorities in the Road Needs Study?
    - How will the community be engaged in the Road Needs Study and Asset Management Plan update?
    - What resources (financial, human, technological) are earmarked for the 10-Year Capital Forecast Budgeting?
    - How do you plan to ensure that the asset management strategy will be flexible enough to adjust to unforeseen circumstances or changes in community needs?
2. **Levels of Service**
    - What specific metrics will be used to evaluate current levels of service delivery?
    - How do you plan on gathering data for the Service Delivery Review? What sources will be tapped?
    - Are there plans to solicit feedback from residents regarding their satisfaction with current levels of service?
3. **Operational Review**
    - What are the key focus areas of the Operational Review, and how were these identified?
    - For the Human Resources Policy Review, who will be tasked with conducting the market compensation and pay equity studies? What benchmarks or comparators will be used?
    - How will the results of these reviews be incorporated into actionable changes?

4. **Waste Diversion – Landfill Management**

    - On what grounds are you basing the expansion requests for Bear Creek and Wolfe Lake Landfills? Are there any environmental impact assessments available? What is the township's long-term plan for landfills? Expansions only last so long.
    - What are the anticipated costs associated with these expansions? How will they be funded?
    - How will the transfer of recycling services to the provincial authority improve waste diversion, and what metrics will be used to measure its success? Compared to the current recycling program.

5. **Communication with Residents**

    - What are the key components of the Communication Strategy Document, and how does it intend to improve communication with residents?
    - What measures will be put in place to ensure that the website information remains updated and accessible to all residents, including those with disabilities?
    - How do you plan to measure the effectiveness of the communication strategies in terms of resident engagement and feedback?

Speaking to sustainable community growth and prosperity:

1. **Clarity and Specificity**:

    - The goal states "sustain and support the current 'quality of life'", but it's important to define what "quality of life" means in this context. What specific indicators are you using to measure quality of life?
    - "Work towards a licensing model" can be more specific. What are the key milestones in the development of this model?
    - The term "rural flavour" is vague. What does this term mean in the context of property standards? Clarifying such terms can make the plan more transparent and actionable.

2. **Measurability**:

    - The objective "Support local business/industry for sustainable growth" is broad. How will you measure "sustainable growth" for businesses? Are there specific targets or indicators?
    - "Improve local business directory listing" is a start but consider defining what "improve" means. Does it mean adding more businesses, making it more user-friendly, or something else?

3. **Stakeholder Engagement**:
    - The plan mentions working with several external entities, like area municipalities, Ontario Provincial Police, and local partners. It would be helpful to outline how these relationships will be managed, and how you plan to engage them actively.
4. **Consistency**:
    - In the property standards section, the timeline for part a is "2023 and ongoing", while for part b, it is "2024-2025". It might be more consistent to say "starting in 2023" or "beginning 2024" respectively.
5. **Budget Considerations**:
    - The plan doesn't mention any budgetary considerations. Implementing these actions, especially items like deferring development charges and using radar speed signs, will have cost implications.
6. **Prioritization**:
    - The plan mentions several initiatives, but it doesn't specify the prioritization among them. Understanding which items are most urgent can help in resource allocation.

Follow-up Questions:

- How will the "quality of life" be defined and measured in the context of the Township of Nipissing?
- Can you provide a clearer breakdown of the milestones in the development of the licensing model for short-term rental properties?
- How will you ensure the "rural flavour" is maintained while updating property standards?
- What specific improvements are you looking to make in the local business directory listing? Are there any metrics or KPIs attached to this?
- Are there projected budgetary implications for the proposed actions, and if so, how are they being addressed?
- Which objectives, if any, are of the highest priority and why?
- Are there any anticipated challenges or barriers in achieving these objectives? How are they planned to be addressed?
- How does the plan ensure inclusivity and that the needs of diverse community members are addressed?
- What metrics or key performance indicators will be used to measure the success of the housing opportunities objective? Are there targets for the number of properties developed or supported?

- How are these strategies integrated to ensure that they complement rather than conflict with each other?

- What feedback mechanisms will be used to adjust strategies based on their ongoing performance?

- How is success being defined for each of these objectives? What Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) are in place?

- What mechanisms are in place to ensure that timelines are adhered to?

- How will you ensure transparency and accountability throughout the implementation of these strategies to stakeholders?

- How many hours were actually put into the development of this plan by our members of council and paid staff?

In closing, I'd like to emphasize that I have multiple concerns regarding other aspects of the plan. However, several of my prior questions remain unanswered unrelated to this, which gives the impression of a lack of timely responsiveness on your part. It's essential for members of our community to receive timely and comprehensive feedback.

A strategic plan is not a static document; it is dynamic and ever-evolving, requiring continuous effort, critical thinking, strategizing, and execution. It's crucial that this plan embodies our community values, enhances our quality of life, and aligns with our shared vision for the future. Given its importance, I urge you to revisit page 6 of the current draft and introspectively assess whether there's genuine commitment on the part of the council and staff to fulfill their roles. This draft, as it stands, does not seem ready for public review and commentary. It does not reflect the standard we expect from our dedicated staff and elected representatives.

If there's hesitancy in developing an effective plan, can we expect commitment in its execution? It's worth pondering if there's a misconception about the roles being merely about attending community events and making appearances. The community requires and deserves tangible progress. If one feels overwhelmed or not up to the task, it might be an appropriate time for self-reflection and evaluating one's future in their current role.

Sincerely,

Joseph Bell

105 Sunrise Drive 249-591-2227